

Student Name: _____

Supervisor: _____

Criterion	Unacceptable	Standard	First Class
Background / Research Question:	☐ Fails to provide sufficient context to allow understanding of proposal content ☐ Does not establish a clear research question, or gap; fails to identify a need for work in the area ☐ Does not identify the potential significance of the work, either for specific field or society in general	☐ Establishes sufficient context to facilitate understanding of proposal content ☐ Establishes a clear research gap and demonstrates that it needs to be addressed ☐ Clearly establishes significance of the proposed research for specific field, or society in general	Standard, plus: ☐ Enables a thorough understanding of proposal content in a concise manner ☐ Defines research question precisely, via reference to current research in the field ☐ Makes a convincing case for the potential significance of the proposed research work
Goals / Objectives:	☐ Incomplete or poorly thought out goals, either too ambitious or too limited in scope ☐ Goals fail to address research question adequately	☐ Goals are clearly defined, appropriate for thesis scope, and achievable within the course constraints ☐ Goals clearly address the research gap described above	Standard, plus: ☐ Precise goals broken down into clear sub-objectives that demonstrate thorough understanding of the project
Approach and Methods	☐ Only vague references to experimental or theoretical approaches provided ☐ Approach or methods incompatible with stated goals, demonstrate a lack of understanding of problem	☐ Clearly establishes experimental or theoretical approach, or possible approaches ☐ Approach(es) identified compatible with goals ☐ Specific method(s) identified, where possible	Standard, plus: ☐ Clearly identifies how approach / methods address goals ☐ Provides compelling rationale for choosing approach / methods
Overall Document Design:	☐ Does not adhere to document requirements ☐ Poorly organized, with redundancies or inappropriately positioned information throughout, lacks clear structure ☐ Grammatical problems and syntax create problems for understanding ☐ Inconsistent attribution of ideas and poor / no documentation / references provided ☐ Aimed at too high or too low of an audience	☐ Meets document requirements for length, format, etc. ☐ Organized well, with content in discrete and appropriate positions in paper, structure clearly laid out ☐ Demonstrates coherent prose with clear attempts at transitions between sections and paragraphs ☐ Demonstrates grammatical correctness and clarity in sentence design ☐ Clear attribution of ideas and referencing ☐ Meets stated audience needs for background / depth	Standard, plus: ☐ Evidence of thoughtful consideration of purpose, content, & the context in organization, writing & design of document ☐ Transitions, paragraph design, etc. strengthen logical relationships between ideas, contributes to document flow ☐ Easy to read prose that concisely and clearly communicates complex scientific concepts ☐ Uses references effectively to frame problem or justify approach

Other Comments (Use back if necessary):

Numerical Score :

/ 10.0